ENGLISH C1 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Extraposition and anticipatory it

Move heavy subject clauses to the end and use anticipatory it to create a readable information flow. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use extraposition and anticipatory it to delay complex information and place evaluation before the proposition it frames while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Move heavy subject clauses to the end and use anticipatory it to create a readable information flow.

MODEL

It is essential that the records remain accessible.

it + be + evaluation + to/that-clause | it + verb + that-clause

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main extraposition and anticipatory it patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses delay complex information and place evaluation before the proposition it frames.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in academic argument, formal recommendations and analytical reporting.

Build meaning before form

Move heavy subject clauses to the end and use anticipatory it to create a readable information flow.

What extraposition and anticipatory it communicates

Move heavy subject clauses to the end and use anticipatory it to create a readable information flow.

The central purpose is to delay complex information and place evaluation before the proposition it frames. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

It is essential that the records remain accessible.	an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position
It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.	an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective
It appears that the original estimate was too low.	a stance marker applied to a following proposition

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: it + be + evaluation + to/that-clause | it + verb + that-clause. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “It is essential that the records remain accessible.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Evaluative extraposition	it + be + adjective + that-clause	It is essential that the records remain accessible.
Infinitive extraposition	it + be + adjective + to-infinitive	It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.
Reporting extraposition	it + reporting verb + that-clause	It appears that the original estimate was too low.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position	Evaluative extraposition
an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective	Infinitive extraposition
a stance marker applied to a following proposition	Reporting extraposition

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in academic argument, formal recommendations and analytical reporting. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04	05	06	07
it	be	evaluation	to/that-clause	it	verb	that-clause

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: delay complex information and place evaluation before the proposition it frames.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits academic argument, formal recommendations and analytical reporting.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Evaluative extraposition	it + be + adjective + that-clause	It is essential that the records remain accessible.
Infinitive extraposition	it + be + adjective + to-infinitive	It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.
Reporting extraposition	it + reporting verb + that-clause	It appears that the original estimate was too low.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

It is essential that the records remain accessible.	an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position
It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.	an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective
It appears that the original estimate was too low.	a stance marker applied to a following proposition

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not let anticipatory it refer to a concrete noun elsewhere in the sentence.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use a for-subject phrase when the agent is already obvious and unnecessary.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not confuse anticipatory it with referential it.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position?

OPTIONS It is essential that the records remain accessible. · It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently. · It appears that the original estimate was too low.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective?

OPTIONS It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently. · It appears that the original estimate was too low. · It is essential that the records remain accessible.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a stance marker applied to a following proposition?

OPTIONS It appears that the original estimate was too low. · It is essential that the records remain accessible. · It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “It is essential that the records remain accessible.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position · an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective · a stance marker applied to a following proposition

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective · a stance marker applied to a following proposition · an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “It appears that the original estimate was too low.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a stance marker applied to a following proposition · an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position · an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"It is essential that the records remain accessible." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Evaluative extraposition / Infinitive extraposition / Reporting extraposition · Gap 2: an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position / an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective / a stance marker applied to a following proposition

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Infinitive extraposition / Reporting extraposition / Evaluative extraposition · Gap 2: an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective / a stance marker applied to a following proposition / an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"It appears that the original estimate was too low." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Reporting extraposition / Evaluative extraposition / Infinitive extraposition · Gap 2: a stance marker applied to a following proposition / an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position / an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position: _____. Choose the model that expresses an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective: _____. Choose the model that expresses a stance marker applied to a following proposition: _____. Choose the model built with it + be + adjective + that-clause: _____. Choose the model built with it + be + adjective + to-infinitive: _____. Choose the model built with it + reporting verb + that-clause: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

It appears that the original estimate was too low. · It is essential that the records remain accessible. · It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

_____ the records remain accessible. _____ the error consistently. _____ the original estimate was too low. State the full structural pattern for Evaluative extraposition: _____. State the full structural pattern for Infinitive extraposition: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “That the records remain accessible is essential.” using the Evaluative extraposition pattern to express an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “To reproduce the error consistently was difficult.” using the Infinitive extraposition pattern to express an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The original estimate appears to have been too low.” using the Reporting extraposition pattern to express a stance marker applied to a following proposition.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “That the records remain accessible is essential.” using the Evaluative extraposition pattern to express an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Evaluative extraposition to express an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Infinitive extraposition to express an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Reporting extraposition to express a stance marker applied to a following proposition, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

It is essential that the records remain accessible.

Evaluative extraposition is the best match because an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position.

A2

It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.

Infinitive extraposition is the best match because an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective.

A3

It appears that the original estimate was too low.

Reporting extraposition is the best match because a stance marker applied to a following proposition.

A4

an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position

The Evaluative extraposition pattern communicates an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position.

A5

an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective

The Infinitive extraposition pattern communicates an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective.

A6

a stance marker applied to a following proposition

The Reporting extraposition pattern communicates a stance marker applied to a following proposition.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Evaluative extraposition / an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position

The structure belongs to the Evaluative extraposition pattern. Its communicative purpose is an evaluation followed by a proposition in end position.

B2

Infinitive extraposition / an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective

The structure belongs to the Infinitive extraposition pattern. Its communicative purpose is an evaluation of an action placed after the adjective.

B3

Reporting extraposition / a stance marker applied to a following proposition

The structure belongs to the Reporting extraposition pattern. Its communicative purpose is a stance marker applied to a following proposition.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

It is essential that the records remain accessible.

Evaluative extraposition: it + be + adjective + that-clause.

C2

It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.

Infinitive extraposition: it + be + adjective + to-infinitive.

C3

It appears that the original estimate was too low.

Reporting extraposition: it + reporting verb + that-clause.

C4

It is essential that the records remain accessible.

Evaluative extraposition: it + be + adjective + that-clause.

C5

It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.

Infinitive extraposition: it + be + adjective + to-infinitive.

C6

It appears that the original estimate was too low.

Reporting extraposition: it + reporting verb + that-clause.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

It is essential that

Evaluative extraposition requires “It is essential that” in this model. it + be + adjective + that-clause.

D2

It was difficult to reproduce

Infinitive extraposition requires “It was difficult to reproduce” in this model. it + be + adjective + to-infinitive.

D3

It appears that

Reporting extraposition requires “It appears that” in this model. it + reporting verb + that-clause.

D4

it + be + adjective + that-clause

Evaluative extraposition is built as it + be + adjective + that-clause.

D5

it + be + adjective + to-infinitive

Infinitive extraposition is built as it + be + adjective + to-infinitive.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

It is essential that the records remain accessible.

it + be + adjective + that-clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended evaluative extraposition effect.

E2

It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently.

it + be + adjective + to-infinitive. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended infinitive extraposition effect.

E3

It appears that the original estimate was too low.

it + reporting verb + that-clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended reporting extraposition effect.

E4

It is essential that the records remain accessible.

it + be + adjective + that-clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended evaluative extraposition effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

It is essential that the records remain accessible. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses it + be + adjective + that-clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

It was difficult to reproduce the error consistently. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses it + be + adjective + to-infinitive accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

It appears that the original estimate was too low. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses it + reporting verb + that-clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____